

Hello

And welcome to the debut edition of NABI. Get ready for an exciting journey through the realms of art, culture, and creativity. I'll be your curator, guiding you through the vibrant landscapes of art, the great outdoors, and entertainment.

I hope you enjoy!

-Olivia Turner

About Me



Before we get started let me introduce myself a bit. My name is Olivia Turner. Most of my friends would describe my personality as an outdoorsy eclectic grandma. This description has never bothered me; I choose to embrace it because it couldn't be more right. When not swamped with schoolwork, I like to spend my free time rock climbing, crocheting/knitting, watching anime and K-dramas, gaming, working out, and going on adventures. If I had the opportunity to drop everything I was doing right now, you would probably find me halfway across the world going on a crazy hike and eating insane amounts of food. However, without that luxury, I am here at the University of Maryland - College Park studying immersive media design.

My diverse set of hobbies is what got me interested in studying immersive media, as I originally wanted to go into game design. But after finding out how overworked and underpaid that industry can be, I've decided to find a new path. I haven't decided yet, but I know I want to make a lot of money so that I can spend it traveling and exploring all there is to offer.

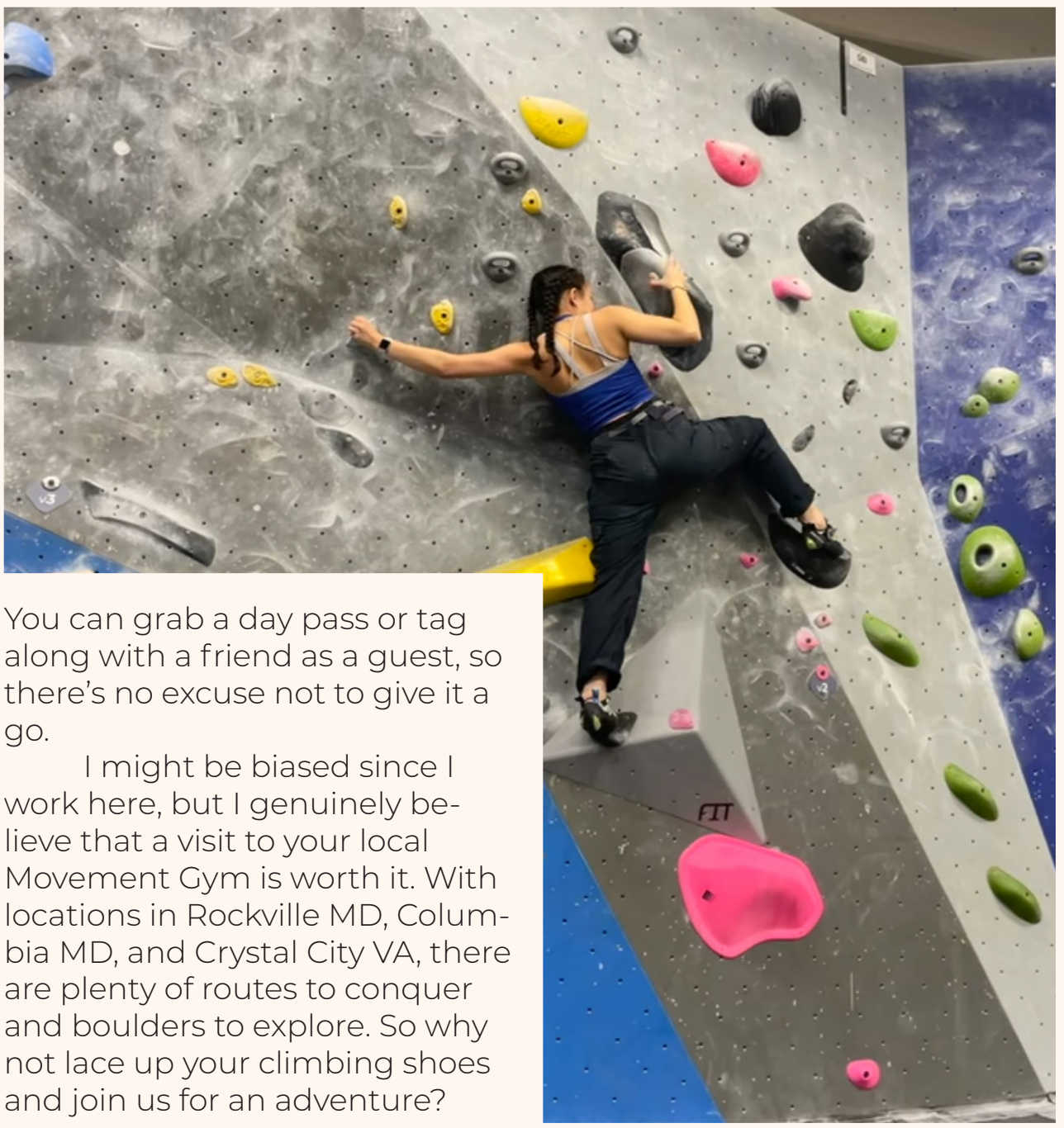
My dream is to one day be a jacked grandma who can climb V8+ before breakfast, and then go back to her cafe where she will bake the pastries she will sell, all before her crochet club meeting with the local grannies where they will talk about the newest episode of their favorite TV show.

Scaling Heights: A Review of Movement Gyms

When I'm not scaling walls at the climbing gym, chances are I'm there for work. And let me tell you, I couldn't have picked a better place than Movement. This gym is a climber's paradise, boasting top rope and lead walls, bouldering challenges, a fully equipped gym, and even a yoga studio. You'll never run out of things to try here.

What sets Movement apart, though, is its incredible community. When I first started climbing and struggled with even the easiest routes, everyone was cheering me on. That supportive atmosphere is what keeps me coming back. I've made countless friends here, all united by our love for climbing and our mutual encouragement as we tackle new challenges.

Now, I know climbing isn't everyone's cup of tea, but fear not—Movement offers yoga and fitness classes too. Whether you're a seasoned climber or just looking to try something new, there's something here for you.



You can grab a day pass or tag along with a friend as a guest, so there's no excuse not to give it a go.

I might be biased since I work here, but I genuinely believe that a visit to your local Movement Gym is worth it. With locations in Rockville MD, Columbia MD, and Crystal City VA, there are plenty of routes to conquer and boulders to explore. So why not lace up your climbing shoes and join us for an adventure?

Anime Artistry: Exploring the Intersection of Art and Culture in ‘The Apothecary Diaries’



With a plethora of amazing new anime releases this past and current season, one that has captured my heart is “The Apothecary Diaries.” This captivating series beautifully blends artistry with cultural nuances, offering anime enthusiasts like myself a rich storytelling experience. Set in a fictional imperial palace, the anime chronicles the journey of Maomao, a talented pharmacist with a mysterious past, as she navigates the intricate web of palace politics and unravels complex medical mysteries. Marketed as a drama and mystery anime, it also features sprinkles of romance for those who enjoy it.

When I first laid eyes on the trailer for this anime, I was immediately struck by the breathtaking animation and art style. The visuals are reminiscent of traditional East Asian paintings, showcasing intricate details and vibrant colors that truly bring the imperial court to life. The meticulous attention to detail in the costumes, architecture, and landscapes adds an authentic depth to the setting, immersing viewers in the world of ancient China. While I’m not usually picky about the types of anime I watch, I can’t help but shower this show with praise for its stunning visual presentation. If you’re looking for a show to watch purely for its aesthetic appeal, “The Apothecary Diaries” is a must-see.

In contrast to many other anime that either focus on Japanese culture or a Westernized magical realm, this series delves deeply into the cultural aspects of ancient Chinese society. It explores themes of class hierarchy, gender roles, and the pursuit of knowledge in a society where women were often marginalized. Through Maomao’s character, viewers witness the struggles and triumphs of a woman endeavoring to carve her path in a male-dominated world.

I’ll admit, watching this show has even sparked my interest in traditional Chinese medicine. The anime’s portrayal of medicine and pharmacy in ancient China is both educational and fascinating. It provides insight into the medical practices of the time, as well as the beliefs and superstitions surrounding health and healing. Maomao’s expertise in pharmacology adds depth to her character, underscoring the importance of knowledge and skill in a world where power often dictates one’s fate. One of the aspects I appreciate most about the show is how, through Maomao’s work and talents, she becomes a respected and reliable figure among the people of the rear palace.

Although I could go on and on about this show, I don’t trust myself to avoid spoiling the mystery aspect, so I’ll keep this brief. “The Apothecary Diaries” is a masterful anime that seamlessly weaves together art and culture to create a compelling narrative. Its stunning visuals, profound cultural themes, and strong character development make it a must-watch for fans of historical fiction. I’m confident that after watching the season finale, this show will rank among my top 10 favorites, which is saying a lot considering I’ve watched over 150 series.